Loading Records in Data Exchange

In **Data Exchange** you can load subject and name authority records, patron records, and bibliographic records along with their attached item, holdings, or order records. You also can batch load media files.

With the exception of **.media** files, you must pre-process a file before you load it to ensure it is in the proper format for import to the Innovative system. See Preprocessing Files for Import in Data Exchange.

> You cannot undo an import after you load records into the system. If you need to reverse the effects of an import, you must delete the new records individually. To help avoid erroneous record loading, you can perform a test load in **Data Exchange**. When you test load a file of records, the system performs all the functions related to importing the records but does not actually bring the records into the system. This allows you to check for any possible errors before loading the records into the system. This is helpful when you load a file from a new source or if you are unsure about the integrity of the data.
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> The steps that describe how to load a file, below, also indicate what you can do to perform a test load.

To load a file in **Data Exchange**:

1. In **Data Exchange** from the **Select Process** drop-down list, choose the appropriate loading process, for example **Load Bibliographic Records**.
2. Select the file you want to load from the **Data Exchange** file list and choose the appropriate **Load** option.

   Depending on the load profiles set up at your library, you might have more than one Load option, for example:

   - **LOAD a MARC file**
   - **LOAD an unblocked MARC file**
3. The load window displays the **Start Block**, **Stop Block**, and **Maximum Records to Load**.

   If you are test loading a large file, specify a small subset of the total records included in the file in the **Maximum Number of Records to Load** field.

> **Blocked MARC Records**
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> When you pre-process a file, the system partitions the file into fixed-size blocks of data (typically, there are 256 bytes in a block). For example, if a particular MARC record is 1100 bytes long and the block size is 256 bytes, the MARC record uses five blocks (1280 bytes) in the pre-processed file (the extra 180 bytes in the last block are unused). The next record in the file begins in the following block.
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> When the system starts loading records from the file, it loads the **Start Block** number, which the system assumes contains a MARC leader, and determines the total number of blocks for the record based on the leader's record size field. It then loads the blocks, assembles them into a complete MARC record, and places this record into your Innovative database. As each subsequent record is loaded, the system loads the block which follows the last record loaded, reads its leader, and then loads the number of blocks required to assemble the record. If the **Start Block** does not contain a valid MARC leader, the system rejects the block and all subsequent blocks until it finds one that contains a MARC leader.

The system stops reading the file after loading the last block in the file, unless you specify a different number in the **Stop Block** field. For example, if the **Stop Block** is set to "73," but a MARC record spans blocks 71 through 75, the system loads the entire record into the database before it ceases.

Although the system can determine the number of blocks in a file before the load (based on the size of the file), it cannot determine the number of MARC records contained in the file until it has completely loaded the file. This is because the number of blocks in each record depends on the individual record's length. You can view unblocked MARC records in a file by selecting the file and then choosing **View**.

If the file has not previously been loaded, the **Start Block** shows '1' and the **Stop Block** shows the last block number in the file. If the **Start Block** is one digit higher than the **Stop Block**, this indicates the file already has been loaded.

4. To save a list of the records that were created or overlaid during the load process, choose **Use Review Files**. For more information, see Using Review Files.
5. To check the integrity of the data before loading, choose **Test**. The system performs the processing that occurs during a load but does not actually load the records into the database. The system generates an error log called **<filename>.errlog (testing)**.

   If the **Output Messages** list any errors, you can **Close** this window, and view the error log.
6. When you are ready to import the records, choose **Load** in the loading window.

   If there appear to be problems with the load, you can stop the process by choosing **Cancel** in the Executing Commands progress dialog. When you choose **Cancel** the load process ceases, but the system does not delete any records already loaded.
7. (Optional) To print the **Output Messages** choose one of the following:
   - **File | Print (<default printer>)**
   - **File | Select Printer** and specify a printer.

   See Printing in Sierra for more information.
8. Choose **File | Close** when you are finished.

Using Review Files

To create a review file of records that were created or overlaid by a MARC file load process:

1. When loading a file, in the load window choose **Use Review Files**.
2. When you are finished loading the file, change to the **Create Lists** function.
3. Select an empty review file or a review file you want to replace and choose **Copy**.

   When retrieving a system-generated review file, you have the option to remove the file being copied. In most cases, you should choose **OK** to remove the file when prompted. An accumulation of system-generated files can cause staff to spend extra time locating and deleting unwanted files.
4. Select the appropriate file. The file name includes a "Load:" prefix and then indicates the action, the file that was loaded, the record type, and the number of records, for example:

   Load: inserted records for beckett.marc (b) (4)

See also:

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